

Farmers and rural communities face many risks to their business. These include droughts, natural disasters, pests and diseases, and other market disruptions.

There are programs and services to help you prepare for, manage and recover from these events.

Rural support

Help in hard times, including drought

- [Farm Household Allowance](#)

Check if you're eligible for up to 4 years of support. For farming families experiencing financial hardship.

- [Rural Financial Counsellors](#)

Get free, independent financial counselling. For eligible primary producers and small businesses experiencing or at risk of hardship. Call 1300 771 741.

- [Concessional loans](#)

Eligible farmers or farm-related small businesses can apply for a low-cost RIC (Regional Investment Corporation) loan.

- [Mental health support](#)

Call Lifeline on 13 11 14 or find other social support.

- [ATO support in difficult times](#)

Check if you can get more time to lodge and pay tax.

- [Tax concessions](#)

Find out about tax concessions. You may be able to spread or defer profits from the forced disposal or death of livestock.

Help to prepare and grow

Whether you're preparing for drought or growing your business, there's help available. You don't need to be in hardship to be eligible.

- [Farm Business Resilience Program](#)

Explore subsidised learning and development opportunities in strategic business management, farm risk management and decision-making, natural resource management, and personal and social resilience.

- [Farm Management Deposit Scheme](#)

Set aside pre-tax income in good years that you can draw on in future years when you need it.

- [Concessional loans](#)

Apply for a low-cost loan from the RIC (Regional Investment Corporation). For an eligible farm business.

- [My Climate View](#)

Explore climate information for your location and commodity, wherever you are across Australia. Supported by the Future Drought Fund.

- [Tax deductions](#)

For infrastructure such as fencing, dams, pumps, silos, bins, landcare operations and carbon sink forests.

- [Income tax averaging](#)

Even out your income and tax payable to allow for fluctuations.

Fact sheets

Download

[Rural support fact sheet \(PDF 392 KB\)](#) [Rural support fact sheet \(DOCX 220 KB\)](#)

[Australian Government support across the drought cycle \(PDF 344 KB\)](#) [Australian Government support across the drought cycle \(DOCX 244 KB\)](#)

[Hardship support for wild catch fishers and aquaculturalists \(PDF 434 KB\)](#) [Hardship support for wild catch fishers and aquaculturalists \(DOCX 247 KB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#) for assistance.

Drought resources

Find out what support is available through your state or territory government.

Drought support in your state or territory

If you have farming clients or members explore our [resources on drought and rural support](#).

Everyone has a role to play in drought

The sooner you seek support, the easier it will be to stay or get back on track.

See our videos on preparing for and living with drought.

Other resources

Learn more about Australian Government resources available to assist with drought.

- [Support in drought for primary producers](#) – Australian Taxation Office
- [Primary producers – support in drought video](#) – Australian Taxation Office
- [RIC Drought Loan boosts net production customer story](#)– Regional Investment Corporation

Current disasters

Help is available for people affected by current natural disasters in Australia.

You may be able to access support from your Australian, state or territory government. Visit [Disaster Assist](#) for more information. [Services Australia](#) can provide lump sum payments and ongoing, short-term allowances. You can access these if you're directly affected by a declared disaster.

Find out if you're eligible for [Australian Government rural support programs](#).

For our customers

If you're in an affected area and are having trouble paying debts or levy amounts please call 1800 647 531 to discuss your situation with us or email ARhelpdesk@aff.gov.au.

We suspend levy compliance activities in affected areas. This includes any automated correspondence to levy agents.

See more on [support for payment of debt during a natural disaster](#) and [notice for levy payers affected by natural disasters or COVID-19](#).

Learn more about the Australian Government's response. Visit the [National Emergency Management Agency](#).

Market disruptions

Find up-to-date advice on other risks or disruptions at outbreak.gov.au.

You don't have to go it alone

While you decide what is best for your business, there are people you can talk to about your options. They include:

- farm industry groups
- banks, accountants and agronomists
- federal, state and local governments

- charities and other non-government organisations.

Talk to them about how you can:

- diversify your production
- manage price and input risks
- draft farm exit and succession plans
- structure your business in a tax effective way
- access rebates and concessions
- expand your off-farm income
- maintain soil moisture and ground cover
- implement new farm practices and technologies
- access financial, social and personal support.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/ag-farm-food/drought>